

Muncie Redevelopment Commission February 26, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dCEamcs00IU
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Muncie Redevelopment Commission: Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: February 26, 2026

Audience: Community Members, Local Journalists, Policy Researchers

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting of the Muncie Redevelopment Commission (MRC) to order on February 26, 2026.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Perilla, Mr. Rawlings, Mr. Miller, Miss Waggley, and Mr. Low (in the audience).
 - **Absent:** Mr. Bishop.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in the opening, but conducting the meeting.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not mentioned in the transcript.
- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was approved as amended (noting a date correction at the top) by voice vote (recorded via roll call vote of members present: Perilla, Rawlings, Miller, Waggley).

- **Approval of Minutes:** Previous meeting memoranda/minutes were approved as amended by voice/roll call vote.
 - **Claims:** Claims presented by Mr. Wright—including agreements with the Downtown Development Partnership, plot land resources for Gateway Park, and payments to the land bank—were discussed regarding timelines and subsequently approved by a roll call vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:08:42 Resolution 2026-01: Phase 2 Pay-As-You-Go (PAYGO) TIF Agreement for Muncie Mall Redevelopment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff (City Staff) / John Mullhair and Grace Welsh (Whole Property Group).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Representatives from Whole Property Group presented an updated strategy for the Muncie Mall property. Due to unexpected utility infrastructure challenges (insufficient static water pressure for fire suppression, gas line placement) and the pending loss of remaining interior tenants (projected 92.3% vacancy by May), Phase 1 (partial demolition of JC Penney, Sears, and the theater) is no longer viable on its own. The developer proposed a revised Phase 2: complete demolition of the entire mall structure. The total project cost is estimated at \$5,358,959. The commission previously approved a \$2.5 million PAYGO TIF for Phase 1; the developer requested a stacking Phase 2 PAYGO TIF for the remaining balance of \$2,835,856. Developers emphasized that no cash is paid upfront; reimbursement occurs exclusively through tax increments generated by future site development.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None during this specific agenda item.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve Resolution 2026-01 (along with authorization for the board president and staff to negotiate final terms) passed unanimously by roll call vote (Perilla: Yes, Rawlings: Yes, Waggle: Yes, Miller: Yes).
- **00:39:18 Resolution 2026-02: Property Transfers to East Central Indiana (ECI) CDC (McKinley Neighborhood & Columbus Avenue)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff (City Staff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff proposed transferring city-owned and MRC-owned properties in the McKinley/Columbus Avenue neighborhood into the East Central Indiana Community Development Corporation (ECI CDC) to streamline future housing development. During discussion, staff noted the omission of certain properties. A motion was made to amend the resolution to include 734 and 736 North Walnut Street as well as 701 North Jefferson Street.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** The motion to amend and the subsequent motion to approve Resolution 2026-02 as amended both passed unanimously by roll call vote.

- **00:35:33 West End Neighborhood Property Acquisition**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff (City Staff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff requested approval to proceed with steps (appraisals and offers based on the average of two appraisals, with an estimated purchase price around \$150,000) to acquire nearly an entire block from a utility company located between Nicholls and Tillitson, north of Godman. The site is viewed as ideal for future housing due to its proximity to the school, university, hospital, and grocery store.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved unanimously by roll call vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:36:00 Ed Passer (FC Tucker)**
 - Spoke in favor of the Muncie Mall redevelopment project, highlighting Muncie's role as a regional hub. Inquired whether Phase 2 design includes extending Mall Road to Royerton Road, and congratulated Vicki Beach on her retirement.
 - **00:37:16 Nathan Snow (704 East Washington Street)**
 - Addressed the board regarding a delayed facade grant application for porch repairs submitted through James Heimlich. Expressed frustration over communication gaps and missing meetings, noting he took time off work to attend. Board members explained that the facade grant subcommittee currently lacks a full quorum due to recent vacancies awaiting mayoral appointments, but assured him his application is ready and will be addressed in March once the committee is fully constituted.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Muncie Downtown Development Partnership:** Retiring CEO Vicki Beach introduced incoming Executive Director Amanda Holmquist. Holmquist announced her first six weeks on the job, transition support from Beach through March, and promoted the upcoming "Magic City Sip and Savor" event on April 4th at Madjax.
 - **Muncie Land Bank:** Nate Howard provided an update noting approximately 45 properties in inventory, ongoing neighborhood planning work in Industry and Whitley neighborhoods, a Ball Brothers Foundation grant for photographic/video documentation in the Old West End, and an upcoming "State of Land Banking in Indiana" event on March 6th at Madjax.
 - **Adjournment:** Officially adjourned until the next regular meeting on **March 19, 2026**.
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